

How to Organize: Fermi Poker

What you need to run a Fermi Poker tournament. You don't need a big team: two organizers can be enough.

Poker chips	Question cards	Pens and boards	Venue	Tables	Format
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Poker chips

- Plan about 20 chips per player.
- A 500-chip set (around \$60) is enough for 25 players.
- Ask around: some people already have chips at home.

Tip

Does your school or university have a poker club? Host the tournament together with them.

Question cards

- Print the questions from our print-and-play PDFs.
- Use 150 gsm paper. Thicker works too, but isn't necessary.
- 100 sheets (around \$15) print 200 questions.
- A table plays about 10 questions per hour.

Local questions

Write your own Fermi questions about your country, city or university.

Writing down guesses

- Dry-erase pens with mini whiteboards or dry-erase flash cards.
- Couldn't get those in time? Pen and paper work too.

Venue

- Classrooms work. Larger conference rooms are better.
- Round tables are better than square ones for seating.
- Space players out a bit, so everyone can write down their guess privately.

Tables

- Ideally 6 players per table at most. 5 and 4 work well too.
- Put at least one rule sheet on every table.

Freezeout or shootout?

Decide on a format before the event.

- **Freezeout:** as players drop out, move the others to fill empty seats and close tables. The constant rebalancing makes it faster and smoother.
- **Shootout:** every table plays until one or two players are left. They move on to a final table, or to semifinals first. Players who are out can stay seated and keep guessing, just without betting.

Before play starts

Plan 15 to 30 minutes for check-in and explaining the rules. Have drinks, and maybe some food, ready.

Quick math

Players	Tables	Chips	Questions per hour
12	2	240	20
24	4	480	40
36	6	720	60

With 6 players per table, 20 chips per player and 10 questions per table per hour.